

Alex Puskaric

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GitHub: github.com/xanderap25

Data Specialist with a background in Data Science, experienced building end-to-end pipelines that turn messy data into clean, AI-ready structures. Proficient in Python and SQL, with hands-on experience integrating APIs, automating workflows, and creating tools that reduce manual work, including an LLM translation pipeline. Comfortable reasoning about context engineering, structured data, and retrieval quality. Eager to apply these skills to high-stakes problems in wildfire resilience and climate adaptation.

SKILLS

- **Database and Engineering:** Relational Schema Design, SQL Querying, MySQL, PostgreSQL
- **Languages & Automation:** Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL), R, Workflow Automation, Logic Validation
- **Methodologies:** QA Testing and Validation, Technical Documentation, Root Cause Analysis, Cybersecurity Fundamentals

EXPERIENCE

Bizowie, Pittsburgh, PA — Software Analyst

July 2025 - December 2025

- Resolved system discrepancies and logic inconsistencies by tracing data lineage with SQL and Python to ensure reporting accuracy for enterprise components.
- Developed a Python-based automated testing suite and structured data inspection tools to facilitate exploratory analysis and validate system logic.
- Authored comprehensive technical documentation for system behavior and limitations to support reproducibility and internal developer understanding.

Jaster, Pittsburgh, PA — Product Development Intern

June 2024 - August 2024

- Developed data pipelines to ingest, clean, and structure API song data, for an AI-powered lyric search system.

Norwin School District, North Huntingdon, PA — Summer IT Intern

June 2023 - August 2023

- Installed, configured, and validated operational readiness for district hardware while maintaining device inventories and resolving technical issues.

Washington & Jefferson College, Washington, PA — Computer Science Peer Tutor

August 2023 - May 2025

- Assisted students with coursework involving Java, Python, Databases, and Data Analytics.

EDUCATION

Washington & Jefferson College, Washington, PA — Bachelor of Computing & Information Studies Emphasis: Data Science | Minors: Mathematics, German | Cumulative GPA: 3.74 | August 2021 - May 2025

PROJECTS

Manga Translation Pipeline and Desktop App — Python, PyTorch, Ultralytics (YOLO), Ollama, CustomTkinter

- Built an end-to-end computer vision and NLP pipeline integrating YOLO bubble detection, manga-specialized OCR, and a locally hosted LLM to automatically translate Japanese manga pages into typeset English output.
- Implemented concurrent async translation and a multithreaded GUI to keep the interface responsive during parallel per-page inference across the full pipeline.

NCAA D3 Track Analysis — R, ggplot2, dplyr, rvest, httr

- Scraped athlete performance data from public databases and engineered clean datasets using dplyr pipelines.
- Created regression models to predict performance outcomes and analyzed statistical deviations across events.
- Presented findings in a format that supported decision-making around athlete performance evaluation, event specialization, and training goals.

LLM Storytelling Study — Python, PyTorch, Transformers, QLoRA

- Fine-tuned a Mistral 7B model using QLoRA for controlled narrative generation and conducted comparative NLP analysis using feature extraction and statistical techniques.
- Developed a documentation site explaining methods and findings for an undergraduate audience and for academic review.